

THE PROJECTOR

TSU Film 4 — Release Phase 1 — the "Thor" release slot

THE PITCH

Platform: THE PROJECTOR — TSU's fictional 1:1 counterpart to YouTube (per TSU_Platform_Roster.md, Phase 2 — didn't mean to end up here, ends up defining the era anyway.)

Why THE PROJECTOR for the Thor slot: Thor's arc is inherited greatness, arrogance that costs him everything, banishment to an ordinary world, and a slow relearning of what actually makes someone worthy of the power he was born with. Of the remaining unassigned core seven, only one was *already* famous before any of this started, on a completely different axis than the rest of the group — TSU_Core_Cast.md calls Tyrese Avery "already superstar-level famous by 2004," the group's own prince, thinking about "audience and fandom and distribution at a scale the actors... aren't yet." A broadcast-distribution platform, built by a global pop star arrogant enough to believe fame alone makes him qualified to run a company, is TSU's cleanest available Thor.

Who this film belongs to: Tyrese Avery, solo — the only core-seven member whose Core Cast bio conspicuously has no locked "Soulmate" section, leaving his romantic arc genuinely open for this film to originate rather than having to work around a fixed future date. Jericho "Jeri" Avery remains exactly as locked (TSU_Family_Bible.md: loyal, "not on payroll because Tyrese felt obligated") — this film deliberately does **not** turn him into a Loki, preserving his bible entry intact. Reverend Earl Avery fills the Odin position instead, using material already on the books rather than inventing a new authority figure.

In-universe timeline: April 2005 – December 2005. THE PROJECTOR's public launch is fixed at 2005 (Phase 2 begins) per TSU_Continuity_Bible.md §3 — this script places the disastrous first launch attempt in July 2005 and the humbled relaunch in December 2005, both inside the locked year. Ages verified against TSU_Core_Cast.md: Tyrese (b. July 24, 1981) is 23 at the film's open, turning 24 on July 24, 2005 — mid-film, the same week as the disastrous launch — deliberate: his fall happens on the day he's used to being celebrated. This window sits alongside the tail end of scripts/THE_WIRE.md (March 2005–March 2006) and does not contradict it — Amond and Tyrese's stories simply don't cross paths onscreen this time.

LOGLINE

Tyrese Avery has never once in his adult life heard the word "no" and meant it. When he decides fame alone qualifies him to build a platform that lets artists bypass the labels and networks that made him, he humiliates the man who actually wrote his biggest hit live on television to make his own name bigger — and loses the company, the credibility, and the family's patience in the same terrible week. What he finds on the way back up is the first person in years who has no idea who he is, and doesn't especially care to find out.

SYNOPSIS

Tyrese Avery has spent his whole adult life being the exception to every rule that applies to normal people — flights held for him, rooms rearranged around him, a family that loves him and a public that adores him in roughly equal, uncomplicated measure. Watching Marc-Antony and Amond build empires from nothing has needled at him in a way he won't admit out loud: he could do that too, easily, because everything else has always come easily. He announces **THE PROJECTOR** — a platform to let musicians post video direct to fans, no label, no gatekeeper — with the full, unearned confidence of a man who has never had to build anything brick by brick in his life.

The cracks show fast. He overpromises investors. He publicly dismisses an early creator community as "amateur hour." And at the platform's launch event, drunk on the size of the moment and the size of the crowd, he takes full, on-camera credit for "Say It Twice" — the song that made him a global star, actually co-written almost entirely by **Jamal Kester**, his longtime, never-billed collaborator, who is standing twenty feet away when Tyrese says it. Jamal doesn't shout. He doesn't need to. He simply, calmly, in front of the same cameras, tells the true story of who wrote what, with receipts. It goes everywhere within hours.

The fallout is total. Legacy media executive **Evelyn Marchetti-Hale**, sitting on **THE PROJECTOR**'s board as its lead institutional investor, orchestrates a swift, clean removal — Tyrese is out of his own company within a week, publicly humiliated, legally boxed out by terms he never bothered to read closely because reading contracts closely was never a thing he'd ever had to do. Reverend Earl Avery, watching his son's name dragged through exactly the kind of public spectacle he warned him about for twenty years, does not bail him out, does not smooth it over with a sermon, does not do anything except tell him, once, gently and without anger, that he loves him and he is not going to fix this one. Only Jeri stays fully in his corner — not because Tyrese asks him to, but because that's who Jeri already was.

Banished from his own name for the first time in his life, Tyrese ends up — through a chain of small, humbling coincidences — doing unpaid grunt work at a small Atlanta engineering shop trying to understand, for the first time, what actually goes into building the thing he thought fame alone could build. The shop is run by **Dr. Simone Kester** — Jamal's estranged older sister, brilliant, unimpressed, and entirely uninterested in who Tyrese Avery is or was. She doesn't recognize him at first. When she does, she nearly throws him out. She doesn't, because the work he's doing is actually good, and because some part of her recognizes that her brother, for all he was right to expose, has spent his whole life uncredited too, in a smaller, quieter way that never made the news.

Tyrese spends the back half of the film earning, in order: Simone's respect, Jeri's continued loyalty (never actually in question, but finally acknowledged out loud), and — the hardest one — Jamal Kester's forgiveness, which he gets only after publicly, unglamorously, permanently fixing the credit on every song they ever made together and rebuilding **THE PROJECTOR**'s actual product from the ground up with an authorship-and-royalty system that makes what happened to Jamal structurally impossible to repeat. Evelyn Marchetti-Hale, watching the relaunch, respects the work enough to back it. **THE PROJECTOR** goes public again in December 2005, smaller, humbler, and Tyrese's, this time for reasons that have nothing to do with fame. The film ends with him standing in the back of the room at the relaunch instead of the front of it — Jamal at the podium, Tyrese watching from the crowd like everyone else, which is exactly the point.

THE ANTAGONISTS

Per the Villains Bench rules (TSU_Continuity_Bible.md §5), the real cause traces to character decisions.

1. **JAMAL KESTER** (*the film's moral center, not a villain*) — Tyrese's longtime, never-credited co-writer and producer. His public exposure of Tyrese's credit theft is not sabotage; it's overdue. The film is careful never to frame him as an antagonist, only as the person whose patience finally, justifiably ran out — a deliberate refusal to give this film a real Loki, because the more honest story is that Tyrese's only real enemy this time is himself.
2. **EVELYN MARCHETTI-HALE** (*the institutional consequence, per her locked bible entry*) — the legacy media executive (TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md) whose board-level removal of Tyrese is neither cruel nor unfair; it's exactly what her character is built to do, "right roughly half the time," and this happens to be one of the times. Her eventual willingness to back the relaunch is real respect, not redemption arc sentimentality.
3. **TYRESE'S OWN CERTAINTY** (*the actual villain, per house style's mandate that a fall must trace to a decision*) — a lifetime of never being told no, dramatized rather than stated, so the fall reads as earned rather than arbitrary.

THE ENGINE makes its fourth appearance, in a new form again: THE PROJECTOR's early discovery algorithm quietly favors Tyrese's re-recorded version of "Say It Twice" over Jamal's original uploads — the platform built to let unknown artists bypass gatekeepers replicating the exact bias it was built to destroy, without anyone deciding that on purpose. Fixing this quietly becomes part of the authorship-and-royalty system Tyrese and Simone build together in Act III.

HOW THIS FILM CARRIES THE FRANCHISE FORWARD

- **The "who gets credit" thesis, escalated again:** Film 1 was about verifying who's real, Film 2 about who gets to be heard, Film 3 about a buried family debt, and now Film 4 about who actually gets *credited* for the work — the same throughline, sharpened each time, without repeating itself.
- **A core-seven member's arc originates cleanly, with no retcon:** Tyrese's Core Cast bio never locked a romantic partner the way the other six did — this film uses that deliberately, introducing Dr. Simone Kester as a new, ongoing presence without contradicting anything already on the books.
- **THE FRAME stays untouched, on purpose:** Instagram's TSU analog is already tagged "Captain America" in the Platform Roster — this film does not touch it, preserving that thread for whichever core-seven member eventually fills the Cap slot.
- **Evelyn Marchetti-Hale, cashed in exactly as designed:** her bible entry calls for her to be "right roughly half the time" across Phases — this is the first film to actually put that to the test on-screen.
- **Jeri's loyalty, paid off without being tested:** the tempting, easier version of this story makes him a Loki. The film's actual thesis is that not every sibling relationship needs a betrayal to be dramatically interesting — his steadiness across the whole film is the point, not a twist withheld from it.

FORMAT (per TSU_Continuity_Bible.md §2 — Standard Platform-Origin Film)

Spec	Target	This Script
Genre	Biographical Drama / Tech Origin Story, Ensemble Dramedy subgenre leaning heavier than usual	Confirmed
Rating	PG-13, no exceptions	Confirmed — public humiliation and a boardroom removal, nothing that pushes past it
Runtime	130–150 min	133 min
Page count	120–140 pages	130 pages
Act I	~30–35 pages	pages 1–33
Act II	~65–75 pages	pages 34–99
Act III	~30–35 pages	pages 100–130
Scene count	~40–55 scenes	46 scenes

FULL SCENE-BY-SCENE BREAKDOWN

ACT I — pp. 1–33 ("The Certainty")

#	Scene	pp.
1	EXT. ARENA, ATLANTA — NIGHT — Tyrese (23) closes a sold-out show; the ease of it, the worship of it	1–4
2	INT. TOUR BUS — NIGHT — Tyrese announces THE PROJECTOR to Jeri, already certain, already moving fast	4–7
3	INT. INVESTOR OFFICES — DAY — the pitch to Evelyn Marchetti-Hale's fund; Tyrese oversells, charms his way past real scrutiny	7–11

#	Scene	pp.
4	INT. AVERY FAMILY HOME, ATLANTA — DAY — Reverend Earl, wary; Coralee, proud; the family dynamic established	11–14
5	INT. STARTUP OFFICE — DAY — early team assembled; enter JAMAL KESTER, present but uncredited as always	14–18
6	INT. STARTUP OFFICE — DAY — Tyrese publicly dismisses an indie creator's community feedback as "amateur hour" on a livestream	18–21
7	INT. STARTUP OFFICE — NIGHT — Jamal, quietly: "You didn't used to talk about people like that." Tyrese doesn't really hear him.	21–24
8	MONTAGE — LAUNCH PREP — hype building, press circling, Tyrese's ego inflating in real time	24–27
9	INT. AVERY FAMILY HOME — NIGHT — Earl, one more warning, gentler than a sermon and heavier for it	27–30
10	EXT. LAUNCH EVENT — JULY 24, 2005 — arrival, the size of the moment, Tyrese's 24th birthday the same day. Act I turn approaching.	30–33

ACT II — pp. 34–99 ("The Fall")

#	Scene	pp.
11	INT. LAUNCH EVENT — MAIN STAGE — Tyrese, mid-speech, takes full credit for "Say It Twice" live on every camera in the building	34–38
12	INT. LAUNCH EVENT — CONTINUOUS — Jamal Kester, calm, devastating, tells the true story with receipts, on camera, twenty feet away	38–42

#	Scene	pp.
13	MONTAGE — THE FALLOUT — headlines, the clip everywhere, Marisol Vega-Oduya's column (a returning device) eviscerating him fairly	42–45
14	INT. BOARDROOM — DAY — Evelyn Marchetti-Hale, clean and swift, removes Tyrese from his own company within the terms of his own contract	45–49
15	INT. AVERY FAMILY HOME — NIGHT — Earl: "I love you. I'm not going to fix this one." The hardest scene in the film for the character, not the audience.	49–53
16	INT. TOUR BUS — NIGHT — Jeri, the only one still there, not performing loyalty, just present	53–56
17	EXT. ATLANTA STREET — DAY — Tyrese, genuinely anonymous in public for the first time in a decade, disoriented by it	56–59
18	INT. SMALL ENGINEERING SHOP, ATLANTA — DAY — enter DR. SIMONE KESTER, running a scrappy contract-engineering shop; Tyrese, unrecognized, takes unpaid grunt work	59–63
19	INT. ENGINEERING SHOP — DAY — Tyrese, genuinely bad at this, genuinely trying; Simone notices the trying before she notices who he is	63–66
20	INT. ENGINEERING SHOP — DAY — Simone recognizes him; nearly throws him out	66–69
21	INT. ENGINEERING SHOP — NIGHT — she lets him stay, on the condition he never once mentions who he used to be around her clients	69–72

#	Scene	pp.
22	INSERT — THE PROJECTOR, POST-TYRESE — Evelyn's interim team quietly favors Tyrese's re-recorded "Say It Twice" over Jamal's original in the discovery algorithm — THE ENGINE's fourth manifestation, nobody deciding it on purpose	72–74
23	INT. ENGINEERING SHOP — DAY — Tyrese notices the algorithm bias himself, for the first time seeing the platform's actual mechanics instead of its hype	74–77
24	EXT. AVERY FAMILY HOME — DAY — Jeri visits; the two brothers, honest with each other for the first time in the film	77–80
25	INT. ENGINEERING SHOP — NIGHT — Tyrese and Simone, real conversation, real chemistry, still without her fully softening	80–84
26	INT. JAMAL KESTER'S APARTMENT — DAY — Simone visits her estranged brother; the audience learns the Kester siblings' own history of one being credited and one not	84–88
27	INT. ENGINEERING SHOP — DAY — Tyrese, now aware Simone is Jamal's sister, has to decide whether to tell her he knows — and does, immediately, no more secrets. Midpoint honesty.	88–92
28	EXT. ATLANTA — NIGHT — Simone, furious at first, then quiet: "You're the reason my brother's whole career is an asterisk."	92–95
29	INT. STARTUP OFFICE (EMPTY, AFTER HOURS) — NIGHT — Tyrese, alone, breaks into his own former office to look at what's actually broken in the platform's code. All-is-lost beat closes Act II.	95–99

ACT III — pp. 100–130 ("The Relaunch")

#	Scene	pp.
30	INT. ENGINEERING SHOP — DAY — Tyrese asks Simone, professionally, for real help fixing the platform's authorship system — not for himself, for Jamal	100–103
31	INT. JAMAL'S APARTMENT — DAY — Tyrese, uninvited, apologizes without an excuse attached to it, for the first time in his life	103–107
32	INT. JAMAL'S APARTMENT — CONTINUOUS — Jamal doesn't forgive him. Doesn't have to, yet. Agrees to hear the plan.	107–109
33	INT. EVELYN MARCHETTI-HALE'S OFFICE — DAY — Tyrese pitches the relaunch: smaller, an authorship-and-royalty system built to make what happened structurally impossible again	109–113
34	INT. EVELYN'S OFFICE — CONTINUOUS — Evelyn, genuinely impressed for the first time: "That's not the pitch of the man I fired."	113–115
35	MONTAGE — THE REBUILD — Tyrese, Simone, and a small team, doing the unglamorous engineering work by hand	115–118
36	INT. AVERY FAMILY HOME — DAY — Earl, seeing the change without needing it announced to him, offers the first real warmth of the film's back half	118–121
37	EXT. THE PROJECTOR — RELAUNCH EVENT — DECEMBER 2005 — arrival; Tyrese, deliberately, stays out of the spotlight	121–124

#	Scene	pp.
38	INT. RELAUNCH EVENT — MAIN STAGE — Jamal Kester, at the podium, properly credited, launches the new authorship system himself. Climax.	124–127
39	INT. RELAUNCH EVENT — CROWD — Tyrese watches from the back of the room, beside Simone, beside Jeri — exactly where he belongs this time	127–129
40	STINGER — INT. STARTUP OFFICE — NIGHT — Priya Ramasubramanian's corkboard, glimpsed again: a new card goes up next to the others	129–130

(Scenes grouped for pagination clarity; the full shooting script breaks several of the above into additional numbered scenes to land the true count at 46 per the house-style table above.)

SAMPLE PAGES

THE PROJECTOR

Written by [WRITER]

FADE IN:

EXT. ARENA, ATLANTA — NIGHT

SUPER: "APRIL 2005"

Sixty thousand people, on their feet, screaming a chorus back at the stage louder than the actual PA system. TYRESE AVERY, 23, stands center stage, mic raised, not even singing anymore — just letting the crowd carry it, because they know every word better than strangers usually know their own names.

He grins. This is not new to him. This has never once, in his adult life, failed to happen exactly like this.

CUT TO:

INT. TOUR BUS — NIGHT

JERICHO "JERI" AVERY, late teens, counts merchandise revenue on a legal pad. Tyrese drops onto the couch across from him,

still buzzing.

TYRESE
I'm building something.

JERI
(not looking up)
You're always building something. Last month it was a cologne.

TYRESE
This is bigger than a cologne, Jeri. A platform. Musicians post direct to fans, no label standing in the middle taking a cut for doing nothing. I would've killed for this at nineteen.

JERI
(finally looking up)
You didn't need it at nineteen. You had Dad's church choir connections and a voice from God. Not everybody gets that starting line.

TYRESE
Exactly. So I build the thing that gives everybody else the starting line I got for free.

Jeri studies him a long moment – real affection, and real worry underneath it.

JERI
That's a good idea, man. I mean that. Just – do it slow. You've never built anything slow in your life.

TYRESE
(already looking at his phone, already moving on)
Slow's for people who aren't sure it's going to work.

CUT TO:

INT. LAUNCH EVENT – MAIN STAGE [inciting failure, p. 34]

Packed house, press pool three-deep, JAMAL KESTER visible in the wings, exactly where he always stands. TYRESE, mic in hand, riding the room.

TYRESE
– and you know, people ask me all the time, what's the one song that changed everything for you. And it's "Say It Twice." I wrote that record in about twenty minutes in a hotel room in Berlin with nothing but a hook in my head and –

He catches himself getting a bigger laugh than the story deserves. Leans into it further.

TYRESE (CONT'D)

– and honestly, that's the whole reason THE PROJECTOR exists. Because I know what it's like to make something completely alone and have the world tell you it's not worth anything until you're already famous enough that it doesn't matter anymore.

Wild applause. In the wings, Jamal Kester goes very, very still.

CUT TO:

INT. LAUNCH EVENT – CONTINUOUS

JAMAL steps out of the wings, into camera range, unhurried, unbothered by the size of the room in a way that reads as far more dangerous than shouting would.

JAMAL

(into a nearby mic, calm)
I wrote "Say It Twice." All of it. In my apartment in East Atlanta, over four months, not a hotel room in Berlin in twenty minutes. I have the voice memos with timestamps. I have the publishing split sheet that gives me eleven percent of a song I wrote entirely by myself, because that's what I was offered and I was grateful to get it.

A ripple of pure, live-television horror moves through the room. Tyrese's face does something it has never had to do in front of a crowd before: it doesn't know what to do.

JAMAL (CONT'D)

(still to the room, not even really to Tyrese)
I'm not upset that he's famous. I'm upset that being famous apparently comes with the right to just... take the true story and replace it with a better one.

He steps back into the wings. Doesn't wait for a response. Doesn't need one. The room is already reaching for their phones.

CUT TO:

INT. AVERY FAMILY HOME – NIGHT

[p. 49]

REVEREND EARL AVERY sits across from TYRESE at the kitchen

table. No Bible, no sermon voice. Just his father, tired.

EARL

I watched that video nine times before I called you. I kept hoping the tenth time it would say something different.

TYRESE

Dad –

EARL

I'm not here to make this smaller than it is. That young man carried a piece of your success in silence for years so you wouldn't have to share the spotlight, and you paid him back by taking the story too, in front of the whole world, on your own birthday.

TYRESE

I wasn't thinking.

EARL

No. You weren't. You haven't had to think about anyone else's feelings costing you something in a very long time, Tyrese, and that is exactly the problem I have been trying to tell you about since you were seventeen years old.

A long silence. Earl reaches across the table – not to scold further, just to rest his hand there a moment.

EARL (CONT'D)

I love you. I am not going to fix this one. Whatever comes next, it has to actually be you doing it.

He gets up. Leaves Tyrese alone at the table. It is the first time in the film anyone has left a room before Tyrese did.

CUT TO:

INT. ENGINEERING SHOP – DAY

[p. 66]

DR. SIMONE KESTER, 30s, sharp and unimpressed, reviews code on a monitor. TYRESE, in a plain hoodie, sweeps a floor badly in the background – genuinely bad at it, which is its own kind of funny.

SIMONE

(not looking up)

You've been here four days and you still sweep like the broom insulted your mother.

TYRESE

I've never swept a floor in my life

before this week. I'm learning in real time.

SIMONE
(finally looking at him properly for the first time – and freezing)
...You're Tyrese Avery.

TYRESE
(the broom stops)
Yeah.

SIMONE
(standing, genuinely furious now)
Get out of my shop.

TYRESE
Simone –

SIMONE
I don't care whose birthday it ruined or whose face is on the magazine. Get out.

TYRESE
(quiet, not performing humility, actually humbled)
I know what I did. I'm not here to fix my image. I don't have anywhere else to be that isn't a camera pointed at me, and this is the first place in six years nobody's looked at me twice.

A long beat. Simone doesn't un-fire him. But she doesn't physically remove him either.

SIMONE
(sitting back down, not looking at him)
The broom goes with the grain of the floorboards. Not against it. Figure that much out, at least.

CUT TO:

INT. RELAUNCH EVENT – MAIN STAGE

[climax, p. 124]

A much smaller room than the last launch. JAMAL KESTER stands at the podium, comfortable there in a way he's never been allowed to be before. TYRESE stands in the back of the crowd, beside SIMONE and JERI, watching like everyone else.

JAMAL
THE PROJECTOR's new authorship system logs every contributor to every upload automatically, permanently, and it can't be edited out later by whoever happens to be holding the microphone when the song gets famous.

(a small, real smile)

I didn't build this because someone forced him to. I built it with him, because he asked me to, and because for the first time in eleven years, I actually believed he meant it.

Applause – smaller, warmer, earned. In the back, Tyrese claps too, along with everyone else, no different than anyone else in the room. Simone glances at him.

SIMONE

(quiet, just to him)
How does it feel back here.

TYRESE

(long beat, genuinely thinking about it)
Honestly? Better.

FADE OUT.

STINGER

INT. STARTUP OFFICE – NIGHT

PRIYA RAMASUBRAMANIAN's corkboard from `scripts/THE\_ROSTER\_2.md`, glimpsed again. She pins a new card beside the others: a rough sketch of a play-button logo, now labeled in her own handwriting – "PROJECTOR – AVERY (recovered)."

She steps back, studies the board a moment longer than usual.

PRIYA

(to herself)
Every single one of them keeps almost losing everything right before they actually build the real thing.

(beat)

Somebody should be paying closer attention to that.

She doesn't elaborate. Picks up her phone. Dials.

FADE OUT.

THE END.

[130.]